

THE TWO-WEEK TRIGGER TRIAL

A Community Self-Experiment Protocol

Developed by Martin Hamer, RN, Ret. | Hamer Glycan Systems | hamerglycans.com

Cohort 1: Monday, July 13 - Thursday, July 30, 2026 | Limited to the first 150 registrants, then a waitlist

Overview

In 2003, a single dietary change cleared skin I had carried into adulthood - skin that had resisted years of conventional treatment. What started as an accident became twenty-three years of deliberate, structured self-observation, and eventually a hypothesis: the Sialic-Glycan Inflammatory Cascade (SGIC). It proposes that two distinct groups of food-derived molecules - Neu5Gc from red meat and dairy, and ATIs and gliadins from wheat - quietly drive a chronic, low-grade inflammatory process, one that in many people shows up in the skin as acne, rosacea, and persistent oiliness.

This protocol invites you to run a short, structured version of that same experiment on yourself: two weeks of avoidance, one clearly defined reintroduction, and an honest look at what changes. You do not need to believe the hypothesis to participate - only to be willing to observe your own body's pattern and report it accurately.

Who This Trial Is For

This trial is designed for people with moderate to severe, persistent acne, rosacea, or excessively oily skin - a baseline severity of 6 or higher on the 0-10 scale used on Day 0 (see below), present most days rather than occasionally. If your skin is currently clear or only mildly affected, a two-week trial won't give you a meaningful before-and-after signal to report, so we'd ask you to hold off joining Cohort 1.

Before You Begin - Talk to Your Doctor

This trial asks you to change your diet for two weeks. Before starting, confirm with your doctor or another healthcare provider that this is appropriate for you. This is especially important if you:

- Are pregnant or breastfeeding
- Have a diagnosed eating disorder or history of disordered eating
- Take medication that must be taken with food, or whose absorption is affected by diet
- Have a diagnosed allergy or sensitivity to the suggested substitute ingredients (e.g., olive oil)
- Have any condition where reduced caloric or nutrient intake could be risky
- Are currently undergoing active medical treatment for the condition you hope to observe change in, including IV therapies or other ongoing treatments

This is not a clinical trial and not medical advice. It is a structured self-experiment, and you remain responsible for your own health decisions throughout.

What This Trial Is - and Isn't

This is:

- A two-week personal experiment in noticing patterns
- Something you can stop at any time, for any reason
- Something you run alongside your normal life and any treatments you're currently using

This is not:

- A diagnosis
- A replacement for any treatment, medication, or advice from your healthcare provider
- A guarantee of any particular result

What You'll Avoid For 14 Days

Neu5Gc sources - red meat & dairy

Butter, cheese, milk, cream, beef, whey, gelatin, caramel colour, and other dairy- or beef-derived ingredients hidden in flavourings, seasonings, and processed foods.

ATI / gliadin sources - wheat & gluten

Bread, pasta, cereal, most beer, and anything made with wheat flour - including hidden sources in sauces, gravies, and seasoning blends.

Note: this list covers the major, most common contributors. It is not exhaustive. Use the Acnerase app to check specific ingredient labels and identify sources not listed here.

Suggested substitutions

- Butter to olive oil or a dairy-free ("vegan") margarine
- Milk to unsweetened oat, almond, or coconut milk
- Wheat bread / pasta to certified gluten-free alternatives

What Stays the Same

Continue all prescribed medications, treatments (including IV therapies or other medical treatments), and your current skincare routine exactly as you do now, unless your doctor tells you otherwise. The only variable this trial is testing is diet.

Day 0 - Baseline

Before changing anything, record the following:

- Date
- Photo: same location, same lighting (natural daylight, no flash), same three angles - front, left profile, right profile - face clean and makeup-free, same time of day you'll use for every future photo
- Skin severity self-rating (0-10 scale, described below)
- Current medications and supplements
- Current skincare routine
- Any known food allergies

Severity scale (0-10)

- 0-1 - Clear skin, no breakouts or visible redness
- 2-3 - Occasional mild blemish or minor redness
- 4-5 - Regular breakouts or persistent redness, some inflammation
- 6-7 - Frequent moderate-to-severe breakouts, visible inflammation, oiliness
- 8-10 - Severe, widespread breakouts or redness, significant inflammation or pain

Days 1-14 - The Avoidance Period

Fill out one row per day, ideally at the same time each day (e.g., evening). Be honest about slip-ups - they're useful data, not failures.

Date / Day #	Trigger-Free? (Y/N)	Slip-ups (what, when)	Skin Severity (0-10)	Notes (energy, digestion, mood, cravings)

Day 14 - Second Assessment

Repeat the Day 0 process exactly: same photo conditions (location, lighting, angles, time of day), and the same 0-10 severity scale.

Day 15 - The Reintroduction Day

To keep results comparable across participants, reintroduce triggers using one clearly defined meal rather than gradually “eating whatever” over several days.

Suggested reintroduction meal: a cheeseburger on a wheat bun, with a glass of milk - or your closest safe equivalent combining dairy, beef, and wheat in one sitting. If any component isn't safe for you due to allergy or another medical reason, skip it and note the substitution in your log.

Days 15-17 - Monitoring the Return

Track symptoms across two windows: the 6-hour window, where fast, innate reactions (from ATIs) are most likely to appear, and the 24-hour window, where the slower, antibody-driven response (from Neu5Gc) tends to surface. Use the same 0-10 severity scale, and take a final comparison photo on Day 17 under the same conditions as before.

Time Window	Symptoms Noticed	Severity (0-10)	Notes
0-6 hours after reintroduction meal			
6-24 hours after reintroduction meal			
Day after (24-48 hours)			

Optional - Control Track

If you'd like to help strengthen this data, consider running a second, separate two-week period (before or after your main trial) where you avoid something unrelated instead - such as caffeine or added sugar - and rate your skin the same way. This helps distinguish “eating more carefully in general” from the specific effect of avoiding these triggers. Completely optional, and not required to participate.

Registering & Submitting Your Results

Before starting, register through the “Register for the Trial” button on the Two-Week Trigger Trial page at hamerglycans.com. This records your baseline information and consent in the Hamer Glycan Registry.

The registry's automatic check-ins don't yet run on a 14-day schedule, so please also send your daily log and your Day 14 / Day 17 photos and reintroduction notes directly to:

info@hamerglycans.com

Please use the same email address you registered with, so your results can be matched to your registry entry.

Consent & Data Use

By participating and submitting your results, you confirm that:

- You have discussed this trial with your doctor or healthcare provider and received clearance to participate.
- Registering via the Hamer Glycan Registry constitutes providing this consent formally; the points below restate it for anyone submitting results directly.
- You are participating voluntarily and understand you may stop at any time, for any reason.
- You understand this is a self-directed, self-reported experiment - not a clinical trial - and that Hamer Glycan Systems is not providing medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.
- You consent to your anonymized data (severity scores, notes, and, if provided, photos) being used in aggregate for research, educational, and publication purposes related to the Sialic-Glycan Inflammatory Cascade series.
- Photos are optional and used only as you've authorized; you may request that any identifying photo not be used beyond internal review.
- You may request your data be removed from any future analysis at any time by contacting the address below.

Questions or Concerns

Contact: info@hamerglycans.com - or post in the Facebook group.